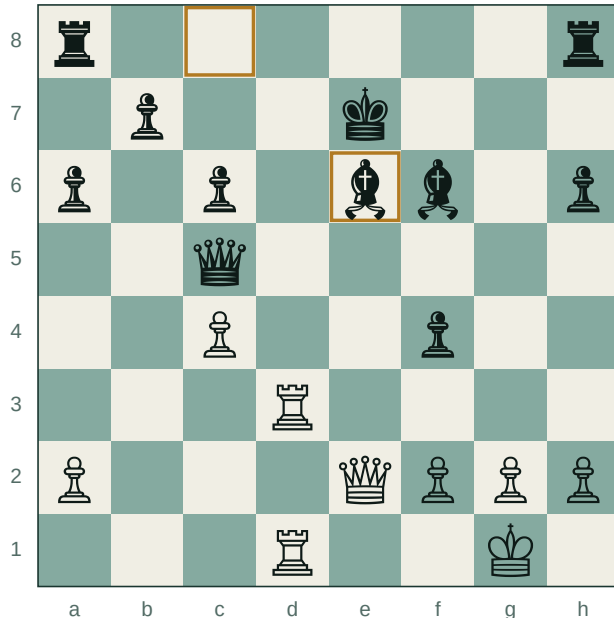


Deflection tactics: White, move 24

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 23...Bxe6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24. Rd7+ Kf8 25. Qxe6 Qe7 26. Rxe7

24.Rd7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **24...Kf8**.

25.Qxe6 The queen captures the bishop on e6. Recorded reply: **25...Qe7**.

26.Rxe7 The rook captures the queen on e7.

At the end, nominal material is White 24 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +12. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +12:** the balance goes from -6 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on e7. Absolute pin: bishop on e6.